CYBERSNOVA

CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP

PROJECT 2

HIDDEN DIRECTORY & FILE ENUMERATION

Enumeration Report

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1. Introduction

Hidden directory and file enumeration is a key step when you start exploring a web application. A website often has more than what you see on its home page, such as extra directories, login pages, configuration-related files, and old files that were never cleaned up. In this project, I carried out directory and file enumeration on the vulnerable training website that was given to us for the internship, and I stayed within the authorized scope the whole time.

2. Objective

- Find hidden or less obvious directories and files on the target.
- Note the HTTP status codes returned for each resource I found.
- Spot interesting resources that could give away details about the application.
- Understand why leaving unnecessary web resources exposed is a security risk.
- Record the commands I ran, what I actually found, and the screenshots as proof.

3. Target Information

Target URL: http://testasp.vulnweb.com/

Target Type: A deliberately vulnerable web application made for authorized security training.

Testing Scope: Only directory and file enumeration.

4. Tools Used

Tool	Purpose	Use in Project
Dirsearch	Looks for common directories and files.	Used to enumerate web directories and files.
Gobuster	Finds directories by trying names from a wordlist.	Run with the Dirb common wordlist.
Dirb	Checks for commonly used web directories.	Used to double-check the directories found earlier.
curl	Shows the HTTP response from a server.	Used for a quick check of how the target responds.

5. Methodology

1. First, I confirmed the target website for this practical.
2. Then I checked the target's HTTP response using curl.
3. I ran Dirsearch on the target to find directories and files.
4. I ran Gobuster with the common wordlist to identify more directories.
5. I ran Dirb as one more round of directory enumeration.
6. I compared the results from all three tools and picked out the resources that looked interesting from a security point of view.
7. I opened the /_vti_cnf/ resource in a browser to see what information it was exposing.
8. Finally, I took screenshots of the practical work as evidence.

6. Commands Used

Target response check

```
curl -I http://testasp.vulnweb.com/
```

Dirsearch

```
dirsearch -u http://testasp.vulnweb.com/
```

Gobuster

```
gobuster dir -u http://testasp.vulnweb.com/ -w
/usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
```

Dirb

```
dirb http://testasp.vulnweb.com/
```

I ran the commands above on the vulnerable practice target that was provided to us. This report contains the results I actually saw during the practical, not sample output.

7. Results and Findings

The enumeration tools found several directories and files. The most relevant results, as seen in my practical screenshots, are listed below.

Resource	Observed Status	Type	Finding
/_vti_cnf/	200 (Dirsearch)	Directory / resource	VTI/FrontPage-related metadata was publicly visible.
/login.asp	200 (Dirsearch)	File/page	The login page could be found directly.
/robots.txt	200 (Dirsearch/Gobuster)	File	A publicly accessible file found during enumeration.
/logout.asp	302 (Dirsearch)	File/page	Redirects to Default.asp.
/aspnet_client/	301 / 403	Directory	The directory exists, but access was restricted after the redirect.
/cgi-bin/	301 / 403	Directory	The directory exists, but direct access was forbidden.

Resource	Observed Status	Type	Finding
/html/	301	Directory	Found the directory, which redirected to /html/.
/images/	301	Directory	Found the directory, which redirected to /images/.
/jscripts/	301	Directory	Found the directory, which redirected to /jscripts/.
/templates/	301	Directory	Found the directory, which redirected to /templates/.
/avatars/	200/visible in Dirb output	Directory	This directory was picked up by Dirb.

Discovered Directory / File List

- /_vti_cnf/
- /avatars/
- /aspnet_client/
- /cgi-bin/
- /html/
- /images/
- /jscripts/
- /templates/
- /login.asp
- /logout.asp
- /robots.txt

HTTP Status Codes Observed

Status	Meaning
200 OK	The resource was found and the server returned it without any problem.
301 Moved Permanently	The resource exists and sends you to another location.
302 Found	The resource sends you elsewhere, but only temporarily.
403 Forbidden	The resource exists, but you are not allowed to access it.

Interesting Finding: /_vti_cnf/

The most interesting thing I found was the /_vti_cnf/ resource. When I opened it in the browser, it displayed VTI/FrontPage-related metadata. The page showed file and application references like login.asp, register.asp, search.asp, default.asp, showthread.asp and template.asp, along with some other metadata fields.

This matters from a security point of view because it gives away details about how the application is structured. An attacker could use this during reconnaissance to understand the application better and find more resources worth looking into.

8. Screenshots / Evidence

The figures below are the screenshots I captured while doing the practical.

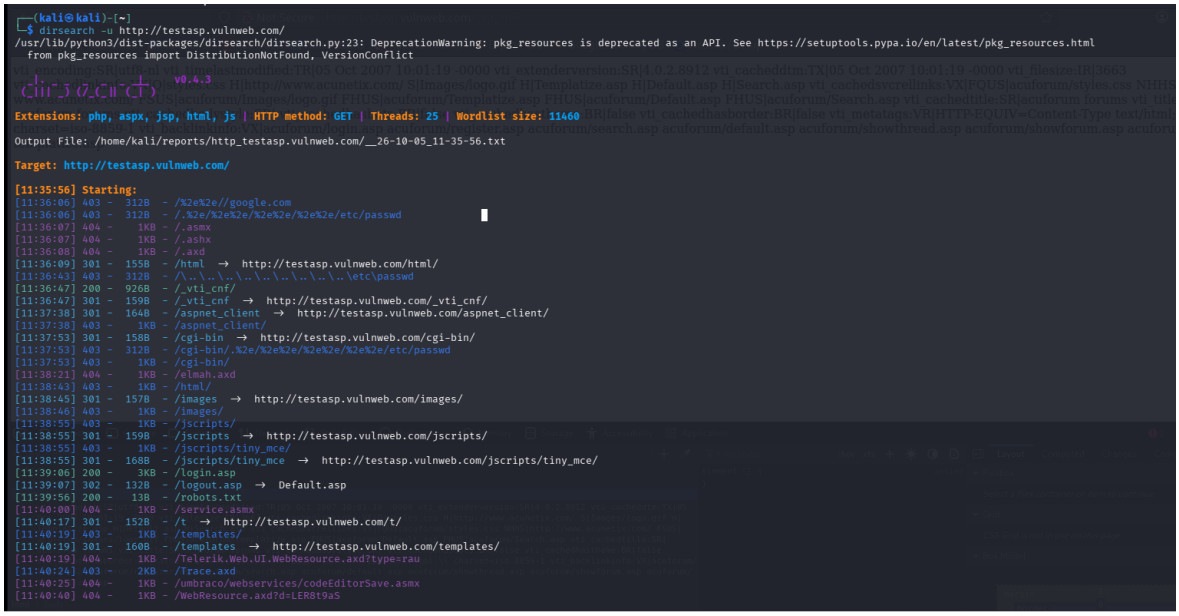


Figure 1 – Output of the Dirsearch directory and file enumeration.

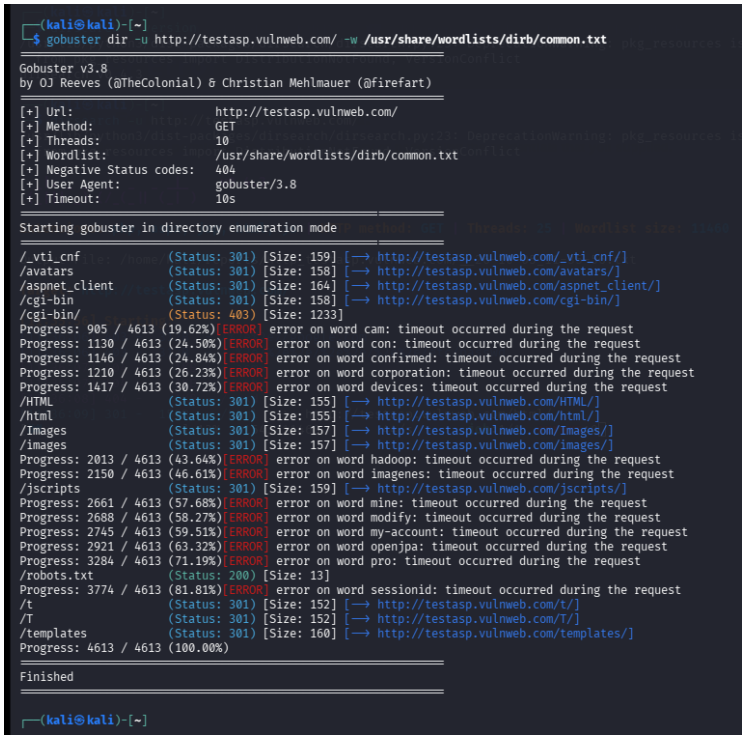


Figure 2 – Output of the Gobuster directory enumeration.

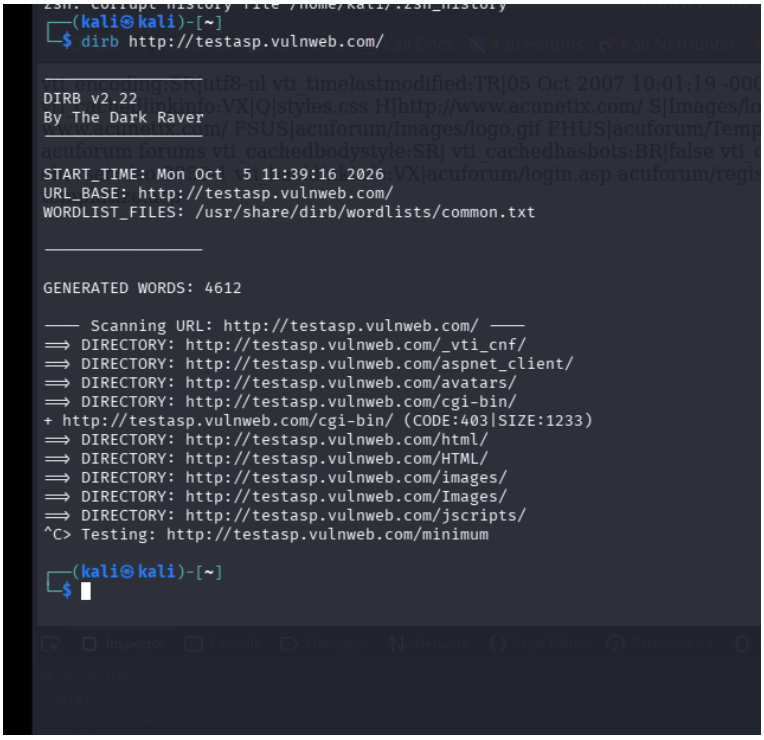


Figure 3 – Output of the Dirb directory enumeration.

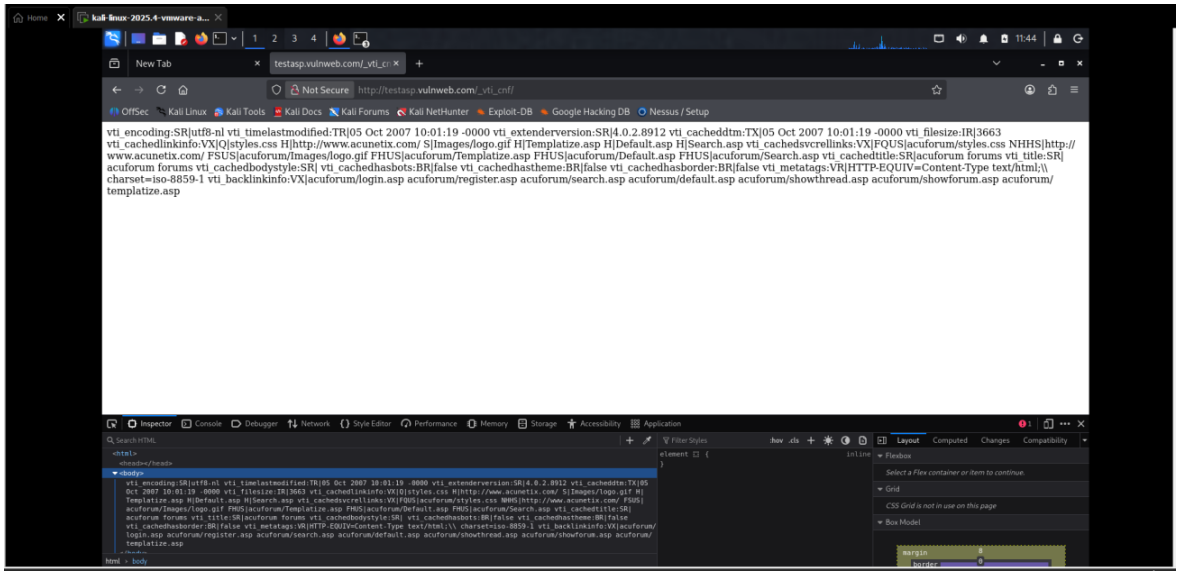


Figure 4 – The exposed /_vti_cnf/ resource as seen in the browser.

9. Security Impact

Finding a directory through enumeration does not automatically mean there is a vulnerability. Still, exposed directories and files give an attacker more information to work with. In this practical, the /_vti_cnf/ resource revealed application metadata and file references, which can be quite helpful during reconnaissance.

Even a 403 response is useful to an attacker, because it confirms that the path exists even though access is blocked. Resources that return 200 are openly accessible, so they should be reviewed to make sure they are not exposing anything unnecessary or sensitive.

10. Recommendations

- Remove unnecessary directories and old files from the public web root.
- Block public access to configuration and metadata directories such as /_vti_cnf/.
- Review the login, script, template and admin resources that are open to the public.
- Configure the web server so it does not give away unnecessary information.
- Get rid of application components that are unused or outdated.
- Run authorized directory and file enumeration checks on a regular basis.

11. Conclusion

This project gave me hands-on experience with hidden directory and file enumeration. I used Dirsearch, Gobuster and Dirb to find resources on the authorized vulnerable website. The results included several directories, login-related files and the publicly accessible /_vti_cnf/ resource. Overall, the practical showed me how exposed application paths and metadata can give away useful information during reconnaissance.

Final Checklist

☐ Name, email and registration number added

☐ Correct target mentioned

☐ Commands are the commands actually used

☐ Actual Dirsearch output added

☐ Actual Gobuster output added

☐ Actual Dirb output added

☐ Interesting /_vti_cnf/ evidence added

☐ Screenshots are readable and numbered

☐ Discovered directory/file list completed

☐ Security impact explained

☐ Recommendations added

☐ Conclusion added

☐ Report exported to PDF

☐ Project folder contains report and screenshots